



IN REPLY REFER TO:

United States Department of the Interior

NATIONAL PARK SERVICE

NEW RIVER GORGE NATIONAL PARK AND PRESERVE
GAULEY RIVER NATIONAL RECREATION AREA
BLUESTONE NATIONAL SCENIC RIVER
104 Main Street
P.O. Box 246
Glen Jean, West Virginia 25846



7.A.2 (NERI)

June 16, 2026

Carrie Kidd
Harmony for Hope, Inc
704 and 708 Main Street
Mount Hope, WV 25880

Dear Ms. Kidd:

I am writing to express my support for the grant proposals submitted by your organization for the New River Gorge Heritage and Visitor Connectivity Mesh Pilot projects. As described, this project has the potential to enhance the interpretation of our cultural heritage in the Thurmond area and other sites within the park, particularly along the river corridor. Thurmond is one of our main cultural resources and is a popular destination for park visitors and school groups. Due to the site's ongoing connectivity challenges, your project appears to offer a promising solution for expanding our interpretive and informational offerings through digital media.

Tourism has become a major economic driver in our region, and in 2024 the park contributed \$94 million to the local gateway communities outside its boundaries. Preserving this valuable resource requires efforts across several areas: research and monitoring, providing information to the public, and, especially in this case, outreach and education for park visitors and youth both locally and beyond.

We look forward to continuing our collaboration on this project as you move ahead. As previously discussed, if you receive the grants, we will need to complete the compliance process before proceeding to ensure that the final product aligns with the historic setting and minimizes impact on both natural and cultural resources.

Please reach out if you have additional questions and good luck with your proposals.

Sincerely,

**BRYAN
WENDER**

Digitally signed by
BRYAN WENDER
Date: 2026.06.17
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Bryan Wender
Acting Superintendent

